

Asset Based Community- Led Development

From Principles to Practice to Policy

Join our 5-day course:
June 15–19, 2026

In Person at the
University of Ottawa

Registration Fee:
CAN \$2,000



What you will learn

- Apply asset-based approaches in community-led development
- Compare needs and asset-based frameworks for policy and programs
- Integrate power, ethics, and local knowledge into practice
- Design participatory strategies that leverage community strengths

Course description

This intensive five-day course introduces community-led development for professionals working in policy and program implementation. Participants will explore asset-based and abundance-oriented approaches and how they differ from traditional needs-based models. Through interactive sessions, case studies, and participatory exercises, the course focuses on practical application, identifying community strengths, building collaborative partnerships, and designing initiatives that support local leadership and sustainable impact.

Who is this course for?

This course is targetted towards people who work with communities, or partner with those who work with communities, in Canada or in the Global South. While most available training on ABCD focuses on practioner skills, this course will also be of interest to government officials, foundation leaders and those who design interventions that support and influence community change.

Why is this course is important?

In a context of evolving global challenges and shifting development priorities, effective international assistance must be rooted in local realities. Asset-based and community-led development approaches emphasize local knowledge, leadership, and existing strengths. By building trust-based partnerships and meaningful engagement with communities, these approaches lead to more relevant, resilient, and sustainable development outcomes.

Instructors

Martha Fanjoy, *Director of Programs, Coady Institute, St. Francis Xavier University*

Martha Fanjoy has over 15 years of experience in applied research, teaching, and program development in Canada and internationally. She has worked across the non-profit and post-secondary sectors, with expertise in program design and delivery, research, policy, and leadership. Her research focuses on ethnographic and participatory methods to explore belonging, community building, and placemaking, with particular interest in forced migration. She also teaches research methods, anthropological theory, human rights, and community development. Martha holds a PhD and MA in Social Cultural Anthropology from the University of Toronto and a Graduate Diploma in Forced Migration and Refugee Studies from the American University in Cairo.

Jim Delaney, *Executive Director, Global Development Policy and Practice Hub, University of Ottawa*

Jim Delaney is Executive Director of the Global Development Policy and Practice Hub. He joined the University of Ottawa in 2026 following more than a decade with World University Service of Canada, where he served as Director of Technical Services. Jim teaches in experiential learning, adaptive management, organizational learning and systems thinking. Jim has published on community economic development, cross-sector collaboration and policy engagement, and has consulted for the World Bank, the International Fund for Agricultural Development, the Asian Development Bank among others. He holds an MA in Political Science and an MBA with a focus on strategy and innovation.



The Coady Institute

Established in 1959 by St. Francis Xavier University (StFX), Coady Institute is committed to accompanying generations of global leaders skilled in the application of citizen-led, asset-based, and community-driven leadership for economic and social change. The Institute was named in honour of Rev. Dr. Moses Coady, a prominent founder of the Antigonish Movement – a people's movement for economic and social justice that began in Nova Scotia during the 1920s. In collaboration with partners in Canada and across the globe, the Institute is committed to reducing poverty and transforming societies by strengthening local economies, by building resilient communities, and by promoting social accountability and good governance. Located in Mi'kma'ki, the ancestral and unceded territory of the Mi'kmaq People, on the campus of StFX, Antigonish, Nova Scotia, Coady Institute includes a network of more than 10,000 graduates in 146 countries globally.

Global Development Policy and Practice Hub

The newly created School of International Development and Global Studies' (SIDGS) Global Development Policy & Practice Hub aims to support the integration of academic research with the world of development practice. The Hub focuses on the creation and delivery of professional skills training in international development in collaboration with civil society partners, especially from the Global South. It also aims to participate in public debates about the role and value of development assistance through the publication of a Hub-branded policy paper series, and the occasional hosting of speaking events. Students will be integrated into all facets of the Hub's activities, thus allowing them to gain job relevant experience in the policy and practice of international development.



Application Deadline

Applications are accepted on a rolling basis until **May 15, 2026**.

The course registration fee is **CAD \$2,000**.

Applications will be reviewed, and selected participants will receive further information. Additional details may be requested as part of the review process.

Registration Links

To register for the course, complete the following application form:

**Asset-Based Community Led Development:
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Or scan the QR code :

